I had not given up on the idea of finding a haven where we might do our work in peace. Sweden looked possible. It was regarded as an independent, liberal country, with a Freedom of Information Act going back to the 1780s and a Constitution that makes special and lengthy provision for the protection of press freedom. Sources are better off in Sweden than in most places in the world: there is a right to anonymity and penalties for journalists who promise but fail to protect the people who privately give them information. To gain protection from prior restraint, it is necessary in Sweden to have both a publishing certificate and to be working for a listed, responsible editor. I went to Sweden with that in mind, hoping to gain a certificate and also to put myself in the position of becoming an accredited editor. You need to have an income for this, so I agreed to become a columnist for *Expressen*, the largest Swedish newspaper.

I hoped we might be able to open a journalistic office for WikiLeaks in Stockholm and began moving towards this. So, Sweden represented two things to me at that point, a future working environment and a safe haven, which makes what happened next taste all the more bitter. Before going, I arranged as usual an invitation to speak, this time for the political party known as the Brotherhood, who are part of the Christian Social Democrats. I arrived on 11 August. And, just at the point of arrival, I received some news from one of our contacts in a Western intelligence agency, confirming what had already been hinted at by the Pentagon press office. The word was that the US government acknowledged privately that I would be difficult to prosecute but were already talking about ‘dealing with you illegally’, as my source put it. The source specified what that would mean: gaining evidence about what we had in the way of information; unearthing, by whatever means, some sort of link between Private Manning and WikiLeaks; and, if all else failed, deploying other illegal means, such as planting drugs on me, ‘finding’ child pornography on my hardware, or seeking to embroil me in allegations of immoral conduct.

The message was that I would not be threatened physically. I told Frank Rieger, a supporter in Berlin who is the chief technology officer at CryptoPhone, a company that makes telephones for encrypted secure communication, and he said he would prepare a press release making this information public. He then did so, and I had it with me on a laptop, ready to edit it. The intention was to get it out as soon as possible, as it did no good to put these things out after some damage had been done, or material